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भारतीय प्रौद्योगिकी संस्थान धारवाड
INDIAN INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY DHARWAD

॥ सा विद्या या विमुक्तये ॥

IIT Dharwad - Freshers' Handbook Academic Year 2026–27

FRESHERS' HANDBOOK

Your Guide to Student Life in IIT Dharwad



॥ सा विद्या या विमुक्तये ॥

Academic Year 2026–27

Prepared by the Student Welfare Section
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Welcome Messages

A Message from the Dean, Students' Welfare



Dear Freshers,

On behalf of the Institute, I extend a warm welcome to the academic community of IIT Dharwad. Your admission here reflects sustained effort, discipline, and intellectual ability, built up over several demanding years. It is worth remembering, however, that qualifying for an IIT is not an endpoint. It is the beginning of a more open-ended and, in many ways, more demanding phase of learning.

As the Dean of Student Welfare, my team and I have been eagerly waiting for this day. For months, you have been defined by a number—your JEE rank. Today, I want you to drop that baggage at the campus gates. You are no longer just a rank on a PDF sheet. You are an individual with unique talents, quirks, dreams, and a voice.

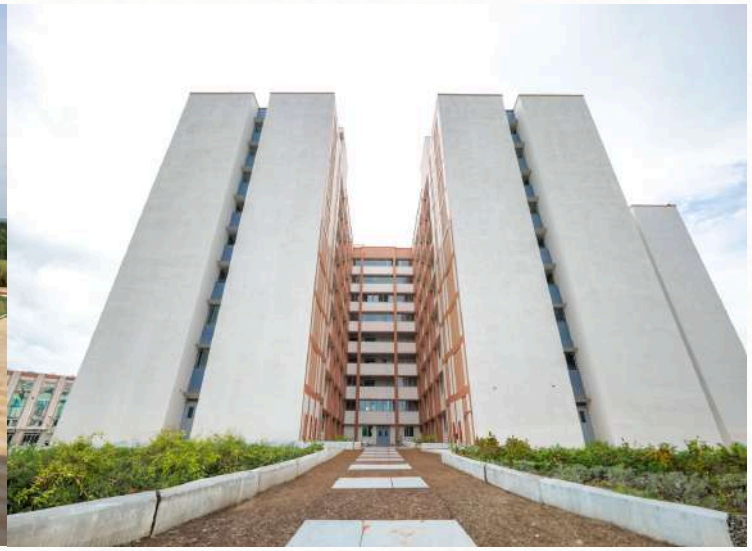
While the faculty at our Institute will challenge your minds inside the classrooms, my office is here to care for you outside of them. Our mission is simple: to make sure you thrive physically, mentally, and socially."

The Hostel Ecosystem – Your home away from home.

"For many of you, this is the first time you are living away from home. You might feel a pang of homesickness, and that is completely natural. But remember, the hostels you are stepping into are not just buildings; they are living ecosystems.

In these corridors, your wing-mates will become your family. You will share midnight meals, celebrate birthdays at 12 a.m., drag each other to early morning classes, and forge bonds that will last a lifetime. You will live alongside peers from every corner of India, representing different languages, cultures, and perspectives. Embrace this diversity. It is the finest education in empathy and leadership you will ever receive."





A Safe Space to Fail and Fly

"IIT is a place of immense opportunity. We have clubs for everything—from robotics, astronomy, and coding to drama, music, photography, and sports. My advice to you is simple: try something you have never done before. If you have never held a guitar, join the music club. If you have never spoken on a stage, join the debating society. This is your safe zone to explore, make mistakes, and discover hidden facets of your personality.

However, amidst the excitement, please remember to take care of yourselves and each other. The transition to college life can occasionally feel overwhelming. If you ever feel stressed, anxious, or lonely, do not suffer in silence. Our campus has a robust, confidential Institute Counselling Service, peer mentorship programs, and medical teams available 24/7. Reaching out for help is not a sign of weakness; it is a sign of maturity."

Our Sacred Commitment



"Finally, let us address the most sacred law of our campus: Zero Tolerance.

We take pride in maintaining an inclusive, ragging-free, and safe environment for every student, regardless of gender, region, or background. Treat everyone with dignity and respect. Look out for your peers. If you see someone struggling, lift them up.

You have arrived here as brilliant individual sparks. Our goal over the next four years is to bring you together into a brilliant, unstoppable fire. My door is always open to you.

Welcome to the family. Let's make these the best years of your life!"

We serve the best, so be the one.

Dean, Students' Welfare
IIT Dharwad

Chapter 1: Arrival and First-Day Logistics

The first day or two on a new campus can feel like a lot to take in at once. This module sets out, step by step, what to expect on arrival so that your move onto campus is as smooth as possible.

Reaching the Campus

IIT Dharwad's permanent campus is located at Chikkamalligawad, on the outskirts of Dharwad, Karnataka. The campus was formally inaugurated in March 2023 and is spread across roughly 470 acres, designed around the theme of a sustainable, green campus. Depending on how you are travelling, here is how to reach it:

- By Train: Dharwad Railway Station (DWR) is the closest, roughly 14 km from the campus. Hubballi Junction (UBL), about 32 km away, is the larger railway hub in the region with wider connectivity, including towards Bengaluru, Goa, Mumbai, Hyderabad, and Mangalore. Pre-paid autos and app-based cabs are available at both stations.
- By Air: Hubballi Airport (HBX) is the nearest operational airport, around 30 km from the campus. Direct taxis are available from the airport terminal, and the Belagavi Airport is around 75 Kms away.
- By Road: The Dharwad KSRTC Central Bus Stand has regular services to and from major cities, including Bengaluru, Pune, Hyderabad, and Mumbai. Private operators like VRL, Sugama, Reshma, etc. Local buses run from the bus stand towards Chikkamalligawad and the IIT Dharwad campus.

Your First Day: A Step-by-Step Checklist

- Once you arrive at the main campus gate, the onboarding process generally follows this sequence:
- Security Screening and Gate Verification: Present your IIT Dharwad offer letter along with a valid government-issued photo ID at the main gate security desk.
- Document Verification: Report to the Central Learning theatre (CLT) at your allotted time slot with your complete document folder, including your JEE Advanced admit card, Class X and XII mark sheets, category certificate (if applicable), and medical fitness certificate
- Hostel Allocation: Proceed to the Hostel Office to complete your room allocation. You will need to submit your hostel fee receipt and a local guardian form before collecting your room key.



A Practical Note on Packing

There is no need to carry large trunks of household items. The student utility store on campus, along with shops in Dharwad town, stocks everyday essentials at reasonable prices. Items such as mattresses, buckets, mugs, extension cords, and lab coats can be purchased after you have completed your hostel check-in, so you can travel light and shop locally once you arrive.

Chapter 2: Finding Your Way Around Campus

IIT Dharwad's permanent campus is organised into clearly defined functional zones. Knowing this layout in advance will save you time, particularly during the first few weeks when you are still getting used to the campus rhythm.

Key Academic and Administrative Areas

- Central Learning theatre (CLT): This houses the lecture halls, smart classrooms, and computational laboratories where most first-year coursework takes place.
- Administrative Block: Located near the main entrance, this block contains the Director's Office, the Academic Section, the Accounts Section, and the offices of the Deans. Scholarship-related queries and transcript requests are handled here.
- Central Instructional Lab (CIL): A well-equipped facility with machining tools, CNC equipment, 3D printing setups, and basic fitting stations, where first-year Engineering Workshop and Introduction to Engineering Practice sessions are conducted.
- Academic Block I (Science Block) & Academic Block II (Engineering Block): Home to lecture halls, faculty offices, and
- department laboratories.
- Library: The central library maintains a growing collection of academic books and journals, along with subscriptions to a wide range of research databases. It is open through the week and is one of the better places on campus for focused, quiet study.

Getting Around: The Campus Shuttle

IIT Dharwad operates a free internal shuttle service connecting the hostel clusters to the academic blocks. This is particularly useful given the scale of the permanent campus.



Shuttle Tips for Freshers

Shuttles typically run at fixed intervals from the early morning to help students reach 8:30 a.m. lectures on time. Carry your student identity card with you when boarding, as it may be checked. Exact timings can change by semester, so it is worth confirming the current shuttle schedule with the Hostel Office or Student Welfare Office once you arrive.

Chapter 3: Hostel Life, Mess, and Daily Routine

Hostel life is, for many students, where the most distinctive parts of the IIT experience take shape. Learning to share space, manage your own schedule, and be considerate of the people around you is as much a part of this education as anything in the classroom.

Your Room and Personal Space

First-year hostel rooms are designed to balance individual study space with opportunities for collaboration. Each student is typically provided a bed, a study desk, a chair, and a lockable wardrobe. Each room is shared by 4 students.You are expected to keep your room and shared spaces reasonably tidy, and to be mindful of the quiet hours observed after 11:00 p.m., out of consideration for your floor-mates.

A Zero-Tolerance Approach to Ragging

Anti-Ragging Policy

IIT Dharwad enforces a strict, legally mandated zero-tolerance policy on ragging in any form, whether physical, verbal, or psychological. Ragging is a criminal offence under Indian law, and any student found responsible for causing distress to a junior can face suspension or expulsion, in addition to legal consequences. If you experience or witness any form of ragging, you are strongly encouraged to contact the Institute's Anti-Ragging Committee, your hostel warden, or the Student Mentorship Programme immediately. Your identity as a complainant will be kept confidential. You can also reach the UGC's 24x7 National Anti-Ragging Helpline, a free, government-run service operating across India.

Helpline	Contact
National Anti-Ragging Helpline (UGC, 24x7, toll-free)	1800-180-5522
National Anti-Ragging Helpline E-mail	helpline@antiragging.in

Mess and Dining

Meals are managed by the Student Mess Committee, which works with the catering team to offer both vegetarian and non-vegetarian options. While exact timings can vary slightly by hostel and semester, the standard schedule generally follows this pattern:

Meal	Weekday Timing (Indicative)	Weekend Timing (Indicative)
Breakfast	7:15 a.m. – 8:30 a.m.	7:30 a.m. – 9:00 a.m.
Lunch	12:15 p.m. – 1:45 p.m.	12:30 p.m. – 2:00 p.m.
Evening Snacks	5:00 p.m. – 6:15 p.m.	5:15 p.m. – 6:30 p.m.
Dinner	7:30 p.m. – 9:15 p.m.	8:00 p.m. – 9:45 p.m.

These timings are indicative and may be revised by the Mess Committee from semester to semester. The notice board outside your hostel mess and the official hostel communication channels are the most reliable sources for the current schedule.

Sick-Diet Provision

If illness prevents you from eating regular mess meals, you can request a Sick-Diet through your mess office. The mess team typically prepares lighter meals, such as khichdi, porridge, or warm milk, which can either be delivered to your wing or kept aside for collection, depending on hostel practice.

Laundry

Most hostel floors have access to shared washing machines, so that every resident gets a fair turn. Check with your hostel office for the specific arrangement on your floor.







Chapter 4: The Student Gymkhana and Campus Clubs

Life at IIT Dharwad extends well beyond the classroom. The Student Gymkhana is the central student body responsible for extracurricular activity on campus, spanning technical projects, cultural events, and sports. It is led by elected student representatives working alongside faculty advisors, and organizes its work through focused clubs.



Technical Council

The Technical Council oversees engineering and innovation activities outside the formal curriculum. Active clubs under this council include:

- Robotics Club: Works on automation, mechatronics, and competitive robotics, with members building and testing projects for national-level challenges.
- Insolvent (Finance and Economics Club): Introduces students to financial markets, case-study competitions, and core economic concepts through talks and workshops.
- Ingene (Motorsports Club): Designs and builds formula-style vehicles, covering chassis design, aerodynamics, and propulsion, and competes in inter-IIT motorsport events.
- Coding and AI Clubs: Run coding challenges, hackathons, and workshops covering programming, machine learning, and related areas, including the campus community for CodeChef.
- Space Data and Science Club: Focuses on astronomy, satellite technology, and space data analysis, connected to the Institute's own Space Data Science Lab.

Cultural Council

This council is responsible for creative expression, performance, and campus media. Notable groups include:

- Sapphire (Dance Club): Covers classical, contemporary, and hip-hop styles, with regular practice sessions and performances.
- Literary and Debating Society: The main platform for public speaking, writing, and structured discussion, including Model UN-style sessions.
- Drishti (Student Media Body): A student-run media group that covers campus events, news, and photography, and is a good place to find current, student-written information about life on campus.

Sports Council



The Sports Council manages fitness facilities, outdoor grounds, and inter-hostel tournaments. Facilities on campus include an indoor sports complex, courts for badminton and basketball, a gymnasium, and grounds for athletics, football, and cricket. The Institute also offers National Sports Organisation (NSO) courses in disciplines such as basketball, badminton, cricket, chess, football, hockey, table tennis, tennis, volleyball, and yoga, giving you a structured way to learn or continue a sport alongside your coursework.

Annual Festivals

Two flagship events anchor the Gymkhana calendar each year: PARSEC, the annual technical festival, which draws participants from across the region for technical competitions and workshops; and HarshtaaL, the annual cultural festival, typically held towards the end of the academic year. Both are organized largely by students and are an excellent way to get involved beyond your own coursework.







Module 5: Wellness, Mental Health, and Support Systems

The Wellness centre at IIT Dharwad functions as a Primary Health Facility, and maintains a confidential, accessible support system for physical and mental health issues.

Physical Health

The Wellness centre has two Allopathy Medical Officers, one Ayurveda Medical Officer, and one Homeopathy Medical Officer. In addition, there are visiting General Physicians, Paediatricians, ENT Specialists, Gynaecologists, and Physiotherapists. In the case of serious ailments, the patient is referred to SDM College of Medical Sciences and Hospital, a premier hospital in this region. In case the student is admitted to the hospital, the expenses (up to a certain limit) are covered by medical insurance. Two ambulances, including one Advanced Life Support ambulance, are available for patient transport.





Counselling and Wellness Support

The wellness centre has two psychological counsellors who are available through the week during working hours. The Wellness centre also has a visiting psychiatrist. In addition, the Institute has partnered with TalkToAngel, a professional online counselling service, which IIT Dharwad students can access free of charge, at any time that they wish. Students may also use TeleMANAS, a telephone- and in-person counselling network connected to mental health institutions in the Hubballi–Dharwad region. Students are free to choose whichever counsellor or channel that he/she feels most comfortable with.

ON CONFIDENTIALITY

Conversations with a counsellor are treated as confidential. Information shared during a counselling session is not passed on to your academic department, family, or peers without your explicit consent, except in situations involving a serious risk to safety, as is standard practice for any professional counselling service.

Medical Emergencies

If you experience a sudden medical issue, please contact the Wellness centre through any of the following numbers:

- Wellness centre Mobile: +91 81474 03386
- Ambulance: +91 89715 23447
- Wellness Centre Landline: 083623 09644

Module 6: Exploring Dharwad and a Short Kannada Primer

Dharwad is a historic centre of education and Hindustani classical music, known for its mild climate and distinctive cuisine. The town is well worth exploring during your time off from academics.

Local Food and Day Trips

- Dharwad Peda: A well-known local sweet. Long-established sweet shops in the main market area, such as Mishra Peda and Thakur Peda, are good places to try the authentic version.
- Khanavali Dining Halls: Traditional North Karnataka eateries serving home-style meals, including jolada roti (sorghum flatbread), stuffed eggplant preparations, and a range of local chutneys.
- Day Trips: Nrupatunga Betta offers a pleasant nearby hill walk, while the historic ruins of Hampi and the forests of Dandeli (popular for trekking and river rafting) make for good weekend trips with friends.

A Short Kannada Phrase Guide

Kannada is the local language, and a handful of basic phrases will go a long way when dealing with auto drivers, shopkeepers, and support staff outside the campus.

English	Kannada	Pronunciation
Hello / Greetings	ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ (Namaskara)	Na-mas-kaa-ra
How much is this?	ಇದು ಎಷ್ಟು? (Idu eshtu?)	Ee-du esh-too?
Where is the IIT campus?	ಐಐಟಿ ಕ್ಯಾಂಪಸ್ ಎಲ್ಲಿದೆ? (IIT campus ellide?)	IIT cam-pus el-lee-day?
Stop here, please.	ಇಲ್ಲೇ ನಿಲ್ಲಿಸಿ. (Ille nillisi.)	Il-lay nil-lee-see
Yes / No	ಹೌದು / ಇಲ್ಲ (Haudu / Illa)	How-du / Il-la
Thank you	ಧನ್ಯವಾದಗಳು (Dhanyavadagalu)	Dhan-ya-vaa-da-ga-lu
I know little Kannada	ನನಗೆ ಸ್ವಲ್ಪ ಕನ್ನಡ ಗೊತ್ತು.(Nanage svalpa kannaḍa gottu)	Nanage svalpa kannaḍa gottu
Do you speak English / Hindi?	ಇಂಗ್ಲಿಷ್ / ಹಿಂದಿ ಬರುತ್ತಾ? (English/Hindi barutta?)	Ing-leesh / Hin-di ba-root-tha?
How are you?	ಹೇಗಿದ್ದೀರಾ? (Hegiddira?)	Hay-gid-dee-raa?
Please help.	ಸಹಾಯ ಮಾಡಿ. (Sahaya madi.)	Sa-haa-ya maa-dee

Emergency and Quick-Reference Contact Directory

It is worth saving these numbers and e-mail addresses on your phone before you arrive on campus, so that they are on hand if you ever need them in a hurry.

Service	Contact Point
IIT Dharwad — Main Campus Number	0836-2212824
Public Relations Office	pro@iitdh.ac.in
Student Welfare Office	studentswelfare.office@iitdh.ac.in
Associate Dean, Student Welfare (Hostel Affairs)	adean.sw.hostel@iitdh.ac.in
Library	librarian@iitdh.ac.in
Career Development Cell (Training & Placement)	tpo@iitdh.ac.in / cdc@iitdh.ac.in
Wellness centre Mobile: Ambulance: Wellness Centre Landline:	+91 81474 03386 +91 89715 23447 083623 09644





A Note on Accuracy

Departmental contact numbers, extensions, and warden details vary by hostel and change from year to year. The most current version of these details is always available on the official IIT Dharwad website (iitdh.ac.in) and through the Student Welfare Office when in doubt, that is the source to check.

IIT- dhArwAD Campus Guide Map

Shape your time here with purpose, integrity, and consideration for those around you.

Welcome to IIT Dharwad.



Parsec and HarSHtAI













Scan & Visit IIT Dharwad Website

Scan & Visit Student Welfare Website

Address :
IIT DHARWAD Campus, ChikkamalligawAD,
DHARWAD-580 011, KarnAtaka
+91 83623 09614
studentswelfare.office@iitdh.ac.in

For more info, visit www.iitdh.ac.in